

commonly infect additional program files as they are run or even just accessed. But there are many non-resident viruses, too, which simply infect one or more files whenever an infected file is run.

File Race Condition

Some applications store information in unsecured files and folders like the temp directory. A file race condition occurs where an attacker has the chance to modify these files before the original application has finished with them. If the attacker successfully monitors, attacks and edits these temp files, the original application will then process them as if they were legitimate. The name of this kind of attack is from the attackers 'race to edit the file'.

Firewall Killer

Any hacker tool intended to disable a user's personal firewall. Some will also disable resident anti-virus software.

Flash Memory

Flash memory became of interest to antivirus researchers when the full measure of CIH's payload was decoded. Because the BIOS of most Pentium-class and later PCs is shipped on a flash memory chip and most mainboard and system designs result in write-mode for that memory being readily enabled, the BIOS of a PC can no longer be considered 'carved in stone'.

Flooder

A program that overloads a connection by any mechanism, such as fast ping, causing a DoS attack.

FTP Server

When installed without user awareness, an FTP server allows an attacker to download any file in the user's machine, to upload new files to that machine, and to replace any existing file with an uploaded file.

FDISK /MBR

If you have MS-DOS version 5.0 or later, the command "FDISK /MBR" can remove viruses which infect the master boot sector but